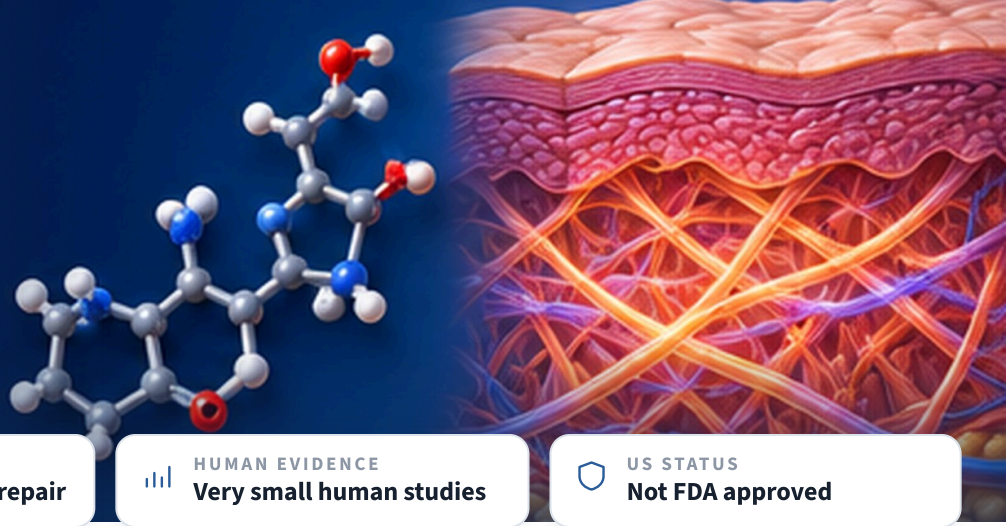
SKIN 05

GHK-Cu (copper peptide)

Three-amino-acid peptide (glycine, histidine, lysine) bound to a copper ion



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide (copper complex)	Wound healing, skin repair	Very small human studies	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

Wound healing	Skin after laser	Wrinkles
ANIMAL	HUMAN	HUMAN

Human data are thin. In the 13-person laser study, objective redness, wrinkle and skin scores did not differ between groups.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

GHK-Cu → Skin fibroblasts → Growth factors → Wound repair

- **In lab-grown skin cells,** faster growth and more bFGF and VEGF
- **In rat wounds,** lower TNF-alpha, MMP-2 and MMP-9
- **In rabbits,** smaller unhealed wound areas than no treatment
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CASE REPORTS
LEVEL 2 OF 5

- Mostly cell and animal data
- 1 small randomized study, 13 people
- 1 case report; Phase 2 wound trial recruiting

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Side-effect profile
- Effect of 1% compounded cream

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	On the skin, in small studies
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established	Skin care products; compounded (Rx) creams
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Skin redness, wrinkles, wound closure	Not named on the 2026 list; class S0 wording may cover it

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved for any use
FDA	Injected forms: Category 2 (possible safety risk)
FDA	Non-injected: Category 1, under evaluation
WADA	Not named; S0 may apply

REFERENCES

1. Miller et al., Arch Facial Plast Surg, GHK-Cu after CO2 laser resurfacing, Jul 2006
2. FDA, bulk drug substances nominated under section 503A (categories 1 to 3), May 2026
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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